■ THE DAILY GOODS STORY SCOUT - Friday, September 11, 2026

TODAY'S RUNDOWN SLOTS

THE LIST (5 stories)

■■ *Russian plot to sabotage undersea cables with "secret weapon" foiled by NATO — clandestine op uncovers training exercise simulating deployment against infrastructure in Norway | The two lines are the world's largest undersea cables*

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): Undersea cable sabotage plots tied to Russia/NATO tap directly into the ongoing Baltic/Arctic infrastructure-security narrative that's been a recurring geopolitical flashpoint.
The Angle: *This isn't hacking a website — it's a suspected plan to physically sabotage the massive cables that carry global internet and communication traffic, and NATO says it caught the training run before it went live. Cable sabotage fears have been building for months, so this plugs right into the bigger 'is Russia testing our infrastructure' conversation.*

- **NATO** uncovered a clandestine Russian operation reportedly rehearsing to deploy a **'secret weapon'** against undersea infrastructure
- The target in the drill: cable lines running through **Norway**
- Those two lines are described as the **world's largest** undersea cables
- It was caught as a **training exercise** simulating the attack, not a live strike

The Debate Starter

- If a handful of underwater cables carry most of our internet, how exposed are we really — and should this freak people out more than it does?

Reddit r/technology (Tier 1) | Score: 86/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 29 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.tomshardware.com/tech-industry/russian-plot-to-sabotage-undersea-cables-with-secret-weapon-foiled-by-nato-clandestine-op-uncovers-training-exercise-simulating-deployment-against-infrastructure-in-norway

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■■ *Jimmy Kimmel’s Pulled TV Interview With James Talarico Drops on YouTube as Texas Senate Candidate Says: ‘They’re Worried We’re Going to Win This Race’*

The Angle: *A TV interview that got pulled from air resurfacing on YouTube is catnip for a 'what are they hiding' conversation, and it's got a real political edge since the guy in it is running for Senate and saying the quiet part out loud.*

- **Jimmy Kimmel**'s interview with **James Talarico** was reportedly pulled from TV before it aired.
- The full conversation has now surfaced on **YouTube** instead.
- **Talarico**, a **Texas Senate candidate**, responded with: **"They're worried we're going to win this race."**

The Debate Starter

- Was this actually spiked for political reasons, or is 'the network is scared of us' just a great campaign soundbite?

Reddit r/entertainment (Tier 1) | Score: 82/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 25 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://variety.com/2026/tv/news/jimmy-kimmel-pulled-james-talarico-inteview-youtube-watch-1236857444/

■ *Meet the 9/11 Couple Whose Surprising Love Story Became a Hit Musical (Exclusive) - People.com*

The Angle: *On the anniversary of 9/11, this is the ultimate silver-lining story — two strangers thrown together by tragedy who found love, and now their story is being sung on stage every night. It's a feel-good hook on an otherwise heavy news day.*

The Feel-Good Moment

- Callers: do you know a couple whose 'how we met' story sounds too wild to be true?

People (via Google News) (Tier 2) | Score: 82/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 29 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://news.google.com/rss/articles/CBMipwFBVV95cUxQVjlNRExHcFJib1oyS1pHbXMtbWdnMzZCS0NPNE9jWUJVVDZjRm9rM0VLN2RZV19vZTAzZXBRSWcyWHVCTl90R3hfMTdLNmszem8xSXRqZ2xWcko0aExzNmNxOHdwMmNTeE9Ld2VoVWQwYzNENXFkWndncmxCU0UzZUVhRm96eS1UX0ZBOEdyam00NFp2RkRLTDF3OXdNM1VDV2YyTUotQQ?oc=5

■ *France has banned advertising for ultra fast fashion and prohibited influencers from promoting it, with fines of up to €100,000 for violations. The new law also requires major platforms to disclose where clothing is made and makes polluting fashion producers pay more toward textile recycling.*

The Angle: *France is going after Shein and Temu-style ultra-fast fashion with real teeth — no ads, no influencer promo, and fines up to €100,000 — which raises the obvious question of whether North America should be doing the same thing.*

- France has **banned advertising** for ultra fast fashion brands nationwide.
- **Influencers** are now prohibited from promoting ultra fast fashion products.
- Violators face fines of up to **€100,000**.
- The law also forces major platforms to **disclose where clothing is made** and charges polluting producers more toward **textile recycling**.

The Debate Starter

- Would you be on board if the US or Canada banned Shein-style ads tomorrow, or is that government overreach into your shopping cart?

Reddit r/upliftingnews (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.intertek.com/products-retail/insight-bulletins/2026/1548-france-adopts-landmark-law-targeting-ultra-fast-fashion/

■ *A $50 million gift from MacKenzie Scott is being dedicated entirely to Native students, with $10 million funding scholarships over the next five years and $40 million placed in a permanent endowment to support Native students for generations to come.*

The Angle: *Billionaire philanthropist MacKenzie Scott keeps making headlines for giving away massive chunks of her fortune with no strings attached, and this time the entire gift is earmarked for Native American students — a group that historically gets a sliver of national scholarship dollars.*

- **MacKenzie Scott** is behind the gift — the billionaire philanthropist known for giving away billions with little fanfare
- **$50 million** total, split into two pieces
- **$10 million** goes to scholarships for Native students over the next **five years**
- **$40 million** goes into a permanent endowment meant to support Native students for generations

The Feel-Good Debate

- Is a permanent endowment a bigger win long-term than direct scholarships right now — which would you rather see your money go to?

Reddit r/upliftingnews (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://nativenewsonline.net/education/native-forward-dedicates-entire-50-million-mackenzie-scott-gift-to-native-students-future-generations/

Backup options:

■ *SpaceX sues to block Texas from releasing Terafab tax-break records*

The Angle: *SpaceX is suing to keep Texas from handing over records on the tax breaks tied to its Starbase-area Terafab plant — a classic 'we want public money but not public scrutiny' fight that plays right into the Elon Musk transparency debate.*

- **SpaceX** filed suit to block the release of records tied to its **Terafab** facility in **Texas**
- The dispute centers on **tax-break/incentive records** the state was set to release publicly
- Raises the recurring question of how much transparency companies owe taxpayers when they take public incentives

The Debate Starter

- Should companies get to hide the details of taxpayer-funded deals just because they don't like the press?

Reddit r/technology (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.businessinsider.com/spacex-terafab-tax-break-records-ai-transparency-texas-2026-9

■■ *Polish developer builds app, called Zuckoff, that detects nearby Meta smart glasses.*

The Angle: *Meta's smart glasses can secretly record anyone nearby, so a Polish developer built an app that detects when a pair is close by — this is the privacy backlash story that's been brewing since those glasses launched, and it's got legs everywhere people wear tech in public.*

- A developer from **Poland** built the app, reportedly nicknamed **"Zuckoff"**
- It's designed to detect **Meta smart glasses** in your vicinity
- Taps into growing public unease about being **recorded without consent** in everyday spaces

The Debate Starter

- Would you actually use an app to check if someone's secretly filming you with smart glasses right now?

Reddit r/technology (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://tvpworld.com/95328093/polish-developers-iphone-app-detects-nearby-meta-smart-glasses

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■ *Fed up with Sony, PlayStation fans compile a list of all the times the company said "you own" your games and archive every last receipt*

The Angle: *Fed up with Sony, PlayStation fans compile a list of all the times the company said "you own" your games and archive every last receipt*

Reddit r/technology (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.gamesradar.com/games/fed-up-with-sony-playstation-fans-compile-a-list-of-all-the-times-the-company-said-you-own-your-games-and-archive-every-last-receipt/

CANADIAN NEWS (3 stories)

■■ *B.C. judge tosses drug case, says U.S. agents broke law and violated Canadian sovereignty*

The Angle: *A B.C. judge just accused American federal agents of running an illegal operation on Canadian soil, pressuring a Canadian into a money-laundering scheme without telling the RCMP - and the case got thrown out because of it. It's a rare, blunt sovereignty smackdown that raises the question of how much U.S. law enforcement quietly operates north of the border.*

- A **B.C. judge** ruled U.S. federal agents broke the law operating in Canada
- Agents allegedly pressured a **Canadian citizen** into a **money-laundering conspiracy**
- The judge said U.S. agents concealed their actions from the **RCMP**
- The behaviour was called **"shocking and flagrant"** and a violation of **Canadian sovereignty**

The Debate Starter

- Should American agents be allowed to run undercover operations on Canadian soil without telling our own police?

www.cbc.ca (Tier 1) | Score: 86/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 29 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/world/dea-drug-trafficking-decision-bc-judge-9.7340597?cmp=rss

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■■ *Former PM Chretien to U.S.: 'We bow to no one'*

The Angle: *A former Canadian PM firing back at the U.S. is exactly the kind of cross-border needling that gets patriotic pushback going on both sides of the border - especially with U.S.-Canada tension already a live topic.*

- Former Canadian Prime Minister **Jean Chrétien** delivered a defiant message aimed at the U.S.
- The line - **"We bow to no one"** - is being read as a shot at recent U.S.-Canada friction

The Debate Starter

- Is this old-school Canadian pride or a real sign U.S.-Canada relations are fraying?

Reddit r/canada (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.ctvnews.ca/canada/article/former-pm-chretien-to-us-we-bow-to-no-one/

■ *Poilievre says Canada will never be '51st state' on U.S. media tour*

The Angle: *Trump's talk of Canada as the '51st state' has been a running joke-that's-not-really-a-joke for months, and now Poilievre is going straight at American audiences on their own airwaves to shut it down - that's a story about national pride hosts and callers will have opinions on.*

- **Pierre Poilievre** hit the **U.S. media circuit** specifically to push back on the idea
- The line he's drawing: Canada will **never** be the **'51st state'**
- Comes amid ongoing chatter (largely from **Trump**) floating that exact idea over the past year

The Debate Starter

- Does it bug you that this even has to be said out loud, or is it smart politics for Poilievre to go on U.S. TV and say it?

Reddit r/canada (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.thestar.com/politics/poilievre-says-canada-will-never-be-51st-state-in-u-s-media-tour/article_b6991e9d-05ee-4b58-8f67-4cdc5b9ba609.html

Backup options:

■ *On this September 11, I would like to say a big Thank You to our neighbors to the north!*

The Angle: *On the anniversary of 9/11, a Reddit post is going viral for the right reasons - a heartfelt thank-you to Canadians who took in stranded American travelers, a reminder of the 'Come From Away' spirit that still resonates today.*

- Poster's parents were flying from the **U.S. Midwest** to **British Columbia** for an anniversary trip when the towers were hit
- Their plane, somewhere over **Indiana**, got rerouted and diverted to **Toronto**
- Canadian hosts put them up in a hotel **at no expense** for **6 days** straight
- It took a full **week** to get home, and they never got to take the Rockies rail trip they'd dreamed of

The Heartwarming Callback

- Anyone else got a story of Canadian hospitality from 9/11 - call in, we want to hear it.

Reddit r/canada (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.reddit.com/r/canada/comments/1wdfz2r/on_this_september_11_i_would_like_to_say_a_big/

■■ *Zelenskyy lands in North Bay, Ont., greeted by Ukrainians and allies*

The Angle: *Ukraine's president making a stop in a smaller Ontario city instead of just Ottawa or Toronto is unusual, and it's a reminder of how deep Ukrainian-Canadian ties run outside the big cities.*

- **Volodymyr Zelenskyy** landed in **North Bay, Ontario** as part of a Canadian visit.
- He was met on arrival by a crowd of **local Ukrainians and allies**.
- North Bay isn't a typical stop for a head-of-state visit, which is part of why this is turning heads.

The Local Angle

- Did you know North Bay had that big a Ukrainian community until this?

Reddit r/canada (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.ctvnews.ca/northern-ontario/article/zelenskyy-lands-in-north-bay-ont-greeted-by-ukrainians-and-allies/

■■ *Zelenskyy describes Canada-U.S. tensions as 'strange,' draws comparison to Ukraine and Russia*

The Angle: *Ukraine's president is weighing in on the Canada-U.S. relationship, and the comparison he's drawing — to Ukraine and Russia — is the kind of blunt, geopolitical soundbite that instantly raises eyebrows north of the border.*

- **Volodymyr Zelenskyy** called the current state of **Canada-U.S. relations** "strange"
- He drew a direct comparison between that dynamic and the relationship between **Ukraine and Russia**
- Comments came amid ongoing strain in the Canada-U.S. relationship under the current political climate

The Debate Starter

- Is it wild - or fair - for Zelenskyy to compare Canada's relationship with the U.S. to Ukraine's with Russia?

www.cbc.ca (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.cbc.ca/news/canada/ukraine-president-volodymyr-zelenskyy-canada-drones-defence-russia-9.7340909?cmp=rss

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ENTERTAINMENT (4 stories)

■ *Lily Wachowski: "You've got to hand it to Christopher Nolan for casting Elliot Page in The Odyssey. That right there is the definition of allyship, and the fact that Nolan is going out there, talking up Elliot about how awesome he was to work with speaks volumes about him as a human being..."*

The Angle: *Elliot Page delivers a heralded performance in a $2 billion blockbuster and still can't get his phone to ring — Lily Wachowski is naming the quiet part out loud, and it's sparking a real conversation about how Hollywood treats trans actors.*

- **Elliot Page** says he's not getting calls after **"The Odyssey"** despite an Oscar-nominated turn
- The film is on track to make **$2 billion**
- **Lily Wachowski** praised **Christopher Nolan** for casting Page, calling it "the definition of allyship"
- Wachowski points out Nolan has publicly talked up Page's performance and work ethic

The Debate Starter

- If a trans actor can headline a $2B movie and still not get the phone to ring, is Hollywood's 'progress' just for show?

Reddit r/fauxmoi (Tier 1) | Score: 82/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 25 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://variety.com/2026/tv/features/lilly-wachowski-jk-rowling-harry-potter-trans-the-matrix-1236858104/

■■ *Judge Judy retiring from on-camera TV after 30 years, son to take the gavel*

The Angle: *Judy Sheindlin built a TV courtroom empire that ran for three decades, so word that she's stepping back from on-camera hosting and handing it to her own son is a real changing-of-the-guard moment for daytime TV.*

- **Judge Judy** is stepping away from on-camera hosting after **30 years** on TV.
- Her **son** is set to take over hosting duties, keeping the franchise in the family.
- The move marks the end of one of the longest-running personalities in daytime television history.

The Debate Starter

- Can anyone else actually pull off the 'Judge Judy' attitude, or was that always a one-woman show?

Reddit r/entertainment (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://ktla.com/entertainment/judge-judy-retiring-from-on-camera-tv-after-30-years-son-to-take-the-gavel/

■ *Dolly Parton Airport set for lift-off after unanimous vote*

The Angle: *Dolly Parton is one of the most universally loved names in entertainment, so news of an airport officially taking her name is exactly the kind of feel-good, shareable pop-culture moment that gets people smiling and talking.*

- A vote to rename an airport after **Dolly Parton** passed **unanimously**.
- The move clears the way for the airport project to officially move forward.

The Debate Starter

- If you could name a local landmark after any celebrity, who's getting the honor?

Reddit r/entertainment (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://faroutmagazine.co.uk/dolly-parton-airport-set-nashville-after-unanimous-vote/

■ *Zohran Mamdani shaking hands with Islamophobe Rudy Giuliani at the Sept. 11 ceremony, after Giuliani had tried to tell him not to attend in the first place*

The Angle: *An awkward-as-it-gets photo op is ricocheting around the internet: a tense handshake at a solemn Sept. 11 ceremony between two guys who reportedly weren't even supposed to be in the same room by choice.*

- **Zohran Mamdani** and **Rudy Giuliani** were photographed shaking hands at the **Sept. 11 memorial ceremony**
- The handshake came after **Giuliani** reportedly tried to talk **Mamdani** out of attending at all
- The moment is blowing up on social media as a viral 'did that just happen' clip

The Debate Starter

- Do you take the handshake and take the high road, or was showing up at all the real win here?

Reddit r/fauxmoi (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://v.redd.it/d2bfvlcd6xoh1

Backup options:

■ *Carlos Rodon, Yankees hold off Mets for important win to open Subway Series*

The Angle: *It's Yankees vs. Mets, the one series New Yorkers actually argue about at the water cooler — and this year the stakes are lopsided, since only one of these teams is really chasing something in the standings.*

- **Carlos Rodon** got the win as the **Yankees** held off the **Mets** to open the Subway Series.
- The result mattered a lot more for one side of town than the other, with the two clubs in very different spots in the standings.

The Bragging Rights Debate

- Yankees or Mets — whose season actually matters more right now, and does a Subway Series win even move the needle?

nypost.com (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://nypost.com/2026/09/11/sports/carlos-rodon-yankees-hold-off-mets-for-win-to-open-subway-series/

■ *Odell Beckham Jr. returns to vintage Giants form — in more ways than just his hair*

The Angle: *Odell Beckham Jr. returning to the team that made him a superstar is the kind of full-circle sports moment that transcends football fans — it's nostalgia, redemption, and a little bit of soap opera all at once.*

- **Odell Beckham Jr.** is back with the **New York Giants**, the team where he became a superstar
- Reports describe his start as looking like **"vintage Giants form"** — on the field and with his signature hair

The Nostalgia Trip

- Is OBJ's Giants return the ultimate redemption arc, or just a nostalgia play that won't last?

nypost.com (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://nypost.com/2026/09/11/sports/odell-beckham-jr-returns-to-vintage-giants-form/

■ *'Being Heumann' review: 'CODA' director returns with warm but generic disability rights movie*

The Angle: *The guy behind Oscar-winner CODA just premiered a disability rights doc at TIFF, and reviewers are basically saying it plays it too safe — a good hook for a quick "does every issue movie feel the same now?" chat.*

- **"Being Heumann"** just had its world premiere at the **Toronto International Film Festival**.
- It's directed by the same filmmaker behind **"CODA,"** which won **Best Picture** at the Oscars.
- Critics say it feels like too many other "us-against-the-man" movies — **"soothing rather than galvanizing."**
- The film centers on disability rights, but reviewers call the approach **warm but generic.**

The Debate Starter

- Does Hollywood keep making the same "inspirational" issue movie instead of ones that actually challenge you?

nypost.com (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL:
https://nypost.com/2026/09/11/entertainment/being-heumann-review-coda-director-returns-with-warm-but-generic-disability-rights-movie/

TRENDING TODAY

■ *California bans addictive social media features for children under 16 and tightens AI chatbot rules*

The Angle: *This is a big one because California tech laws tend to set the tone for the whole country - if this sticks, it could force every major platform to redesign how they hook teenage users, and it's the first real crackdown on AI chatbots marketed to kids too.*

- **California** passed a law banning "addictive" social media design features for users under **16**
- The law also tightens rules around **AI chatbots**, specifically ones aimed at kids
- It puts California at the front of the national fight over tech companies designing apps to hook young users

The Debate Starter

- Should every state copy California and ban addictive app features for kids, or is this government overreach into how families raise their own teens?

Reddit r/upliftingnews (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.techspot.com/news/113820-california-bans-addictive-social-media-features-children-under.html

Backup options:

■ *Man Who Had Sex on Download Festival Ferris Wheel Learns He's All Over the Internet From His Boss*

The Angle: *A couple's private moment on a Ferris wheel at Download Festival turned into an internet moment, and now it's reportedly made its way back to his workplace — the ultimate 'when a viral clip finds you' story.*

- The incident happened on a **Ferris wheel** at **Download Festival**
- Footage of the encounter spread online and went viral
- The man reportedly found out his **boss** had seen the clip

The Awkward Monday Meeting

- What's worse — getting caught on camera, or your boss being the one who sends you the link?

Reddit r/nottheonion (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.fashiontimes.co.uk/download-festival-ferris-wheel-sex-video-fine-1763914

■ *A Metal Detectorist Just Discovered Finland's Largest Hoard of Viking Age Silver—But Was It Plunder?*

The Angle: *A hobbyist with a metal detector just stumbled onto the largest Viking Age silver hoard ever found in Finland — and now archaeologists are debating whether it was buried savings or straight-up war loot.*

- The hoard was found by an amateur **metal detectorist**, not a professional dig team
- Experts say it's the **largest Viking Age silver hoard** ever recorded in **Finland**
- By weight alone, the silver would be worth close to **$10,000** today
- The full haul hasn't been officially assessed yet, so the final value could climb

The Debate Starter

- Buried nest egg or stolen Viking plunder — which story do you want to be true?

gizmodo.com (Tier 2) | Score: 74/90 (45 fit + 8 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://gizmodo.com/a-metal-detectorist-just-discovered-finlands-largest-hoard-of-viking-age-silver-but-was-it-plunder-2000810800

LIFESTYLE CHAT

■ *Wisconsin restored former farmland into prairie; researchers found more bumblebees and rare species only at the restored sites.*

The Angle: *It's a rare good-news environmental story: turn dirt back into wildflowers and nature actually bounces back, fast. Great low-stakes chat starter about backyards, lawns, and doing something small for the planet.*

- **Wisconsin** has been converting former farmland back into **native prairie**
- The process includes removing invasive plants and reseeding with **native grasses and wildflowers**
- Native prairie blooms in stages through **spring, summer, and fall**, giving bees food way longer than a single crop field can
- Researchers found **more bumblebees** — and some **rare species** — showed up *only* at the restored prairie sites

The Feel-Good Takeaway

- Would you rip out part of your lawn for a wildflower patch if it meant more bees (and fewer mosquitoes)?

Reddit r/upliftingnews (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://timesofindia.indiatimes.com/science/nature/wisconsin-restored-former-farmland-into-prairie-researchers-found-more-bumblebees-and-rare-species-only-at-the-restored-sites/articleshow/134015977.cms

Backup options:

■ *Californians projected to spend $675 million on OnlyFans this year: study*

The Angle: *It's the kind of eyebrow-raising stat that writes its own headline - a huge dollar figure tied to one state's subscription habits, perfect for a quick "wait, how much?" chat.*

- New study projects **Californians** will spend **$675 million** on **OnlyFans** this year alone
- California reportedly leads the pack among U.S. states for subscription spending on the platform
- Story's already blowing up on **r/nottheonion** for how wild the number sounds out loud

The Reaction Bit

- What's the one dumb thing you'd guess your own city collectively overspends on?

Reddit r/nottheonion (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://ktla.com/news/california/californians-projected-to-spend-675-million-on-onlyfans-this-year-study/

■ *Dating Apps Are Dying*

The Angle: *Everyone's got a dating app horror story, and lately the chatter online is that people are just done swiping — that's a conversation both hosts can jump into with their own experience.*

The Phone-In Trigger

- Have you deleted a dating app this year — and did it actually help your love life?

Reddit r/technology (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://time.com/article/2026/09/09/dating-apps-are-dying/

CLOSER: THE KICKER/GOODBYES (franchise fallback)

■ *Matt Berry is now a sentient Ikea shelf in Skyrim*

The Angle: *A modder apparently gave a Skyrim shelf the voice of actor Matt Berry, and the internet can't decide if it's genius or unhinged - exactly the kind of gloriously stupid gaming story that makes for a great kicker.*

The Weird News Wrap-Up

- Would you rather your furniture talk like Matt Berry, or just stay quiet forever?

Reddit r/nottheonion (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.pcworld.com/article/3233287/matt-berry-is-now-a-sentient-ikea-shelf-in-skyrim.html

Backup options:

■ *Ryanair CEO compares rival airlines to 'rapists'*

The Angle: *Ryanair's boss is infamous for saying the quiet part loud, but comparing competitors to rapists is a whole new level of unhinged — exactly the kind of quote that makes r/nottheonion feel like satire until you check the source.*

- The headline itself is the story: **Ryanair's CEO** reportedly used the word **"rapists"** to describe rival airlines.
- It's landed on **r/nottheonion** — the internet's go-to spot for real news too wild to sound real.

The Outrage Meter

- What's the worst thing a CEO has ever said out loud in public?

Reddit r/nottheonion (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.brusselstimes.com/2312302/ryanair-ceo-compares-rival-airlines-to-rapists

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FLEX (cap check: THE GREAT DEBATE 0/4 this month; TECH TALK 2/3 this month; Advice/Relationship Cluster 4/3 this month)

(no flex-slot candidates cleared the cap/score bar today)

ADDITIONAL CANDIDATES (no specific segment match, but scored well on source/quality - producer's call on where these fit)

■ *68% of US Voters Back Sanders/Casar Bill for AI Pause, Ban on Superintelligence: Poll*

The Angle: *A new poll says over two-thirds of voters back a bill from Bernie Sanders and Greg Casar to hit pause on AI development and ban building 'superintelligence' outright - a sign the AI-anxiety conversation has jumped from Silicon Valley op-eds to actual bipartisan public opinion.*

- **68% of US voters** support the proposed bill, according to the poll
- The legislation is tied to **Sen. Bernie Sanders** and **Rep. Greg Casar**

- The bill would push for an **AI pause** and a ban on developing **'superintelligence'**
- Story is generating buzz on **Reddit's r/technology**, a hub for tech-policy chatter

The Debate Starter

- Should Congress hit the brakes on AI before we even know what superintelligence looks like - or are we already too far behind to stop?

Reddit r/technology (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.commondreams.org/news/sanders-casar-ai-bill-poll

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BREAKOUT WATCH (below the show's usual engagement bar - included on editorial judgment, not metrics; producer's call)

■ *Boy, 15, Drifted for Days on an Overturned Boat Before Rescue*

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): Same rescue story is simultaneously trending on NYPost and Global News feeds (items 40, 49), a rare cross-platform signal that this dramatic survival tale has legs beyond Reddit.
The Angle: *It's the kind of survival story that stops you mid-scroll — a 15-year-old holding on for days before finally getting spotted, a pure gut-punch-to-relief arc that's perfect for a feel-good closer.*

- A **15-year-old boy** survived for **multiple days** stranded at sea.
- He stayed alive by clinging to his **overturned boat** the entire time.
- He was eventually found and rescued alive.

The Feel-Good Takeaway

- Sometimes the whole story is just: he held on, and somebody found him — that's the win.

Reddit r/upliftingnews (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.nytimes.com/2026/09/11/us/alaska-bering-sea-rescue-boy.html?unlocked_article_code=1.AVE.QHel.cTBpKo13Sg24&smid=url-share

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■ *PlayStation Ditched Hideo Kojima's 'Physint' on Budget Concerns, Missed Deadlines*

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): Hideo Kojima is a marquee name in gaming and any story about a cancelled Kojima project gets picked up instantly by gaming press and fan communities.
The Angle: *Hideo Kojima is one of the most famous names in gaming, so word that PlayStation quietly killed his passion project over money and delays is exactly the kind of industry drama that gets fans and casual gamers alike talking.*

- **PlayStation** reportedly cancelled **Hideo Kojima's** in-development spy game **"Physint"**
- The project was reportedly axed over **budget concerns**
- Sources point to **missed deadlines** as a key factor in the decision

The Debate Starter

- Is it fair for a studio to pull funding on a visionary director, or does even a legend like Kojima need to hit deadlines like everyone else?

Reddit r/technology (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.bloomberg.com/news/articles/2026-09-11/hideo-kojima-s-physint-video-game-dropped-by-playstation-goes-to-xbox?accessToken=eyJhbGciOiJIUzI1NiIsInR5cCI6IkpXVCJ9.eyJzb3VyY2UiOiJTdWJzY3JpYmVyR2lmdGVkQXJ0aWNsZSIsImlhdCI6MTc4OTEzMzY2NSwiZXhwIjoxNzg5NzM4NDY1LCJhcnRpY2xlSWQiOiJUTDdDOVdLSVVQVEIwMCIsImJjb25uZWN0SWQiOiJCMUVBQkI5NjQ2QUM0REZFQTJBRkI4MjI1MzgyQTJFQSJ9.fyrTke3aUIkJk3LwiBfR7JiNr0phfE51dlEql1RcXZ4

■ *Gander, Canada, opened its doors after 9/11. Trump's ambassador risks a cooler welcome.*

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): Publishing on the actual 9/11 anniversary with a fresh political hook (Trump's ambassador) gives this decades-old goodwill story unusually sharp timing relevance.
The Angle: *Gander, Newfoundland became a symbol of pure kindness on 9/11, taking in thousands of stranded travelers with zero notice. Now, with Canada-US relations frosty under Trump, the town's reception for his ambassador is being watched as a real barometer of how Canadians feel about their neighbor right now.*

- **Gander, Newfoundland** is the small Canadian town famous for opening its doors to stranded travelers on **9/11**.
- The town's hospitality that day became internationally known, later inspiring the hit musical **"Come From Away."**
- The headline flags that **Trump's ambassador** may not get the same warm welcome, pointing to strained **US-Canada relations**.

The Debate Starter

- Would you still roll out the welcome mat for an ambassador from a president your country's currently feuding with?

Reddit r/canada (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.politico.com/news/2026/09/11/gander-canada-hoekstra-01071859

■ *'Shame on you!' $10K worth of food stolen from non-profit seniors home*

■ **Breakout potential** (editorial judgment, below the usual engagement bar): Appears independently on both Reddit and CTVNews (item 48) with nearly identical framing, and 'stealing from a seniors' non-profit' is a proven high-outrage/high-share emotional trigger.
The Angle: *This is the kind of low-blow crime that gets a whole city fired up — stealing from a non-profit that feeds seniors hits a nerve fast, and it's tailor-made for listener outrage and calls to help.*

- **$10,000 worth of food** was stolen from a non-profit seniors home
- The story's already carrying a viral-style quote — **"Shame on you!"** — aimed at whoever did it
- Details are still thin out of the gate, but the dollar figure and target (a seniors' non-profit) are what's driving the reaction

The Outrage Meter

- Would you turn someone in if you knew who did this — even if it meant a friend or neighbor?

Reddit r/canada (Tier 1) | Score: 78/90 (45 fit + 12 source + 21 quality) -> LEAD

URL: https://www.ctvnews.ca/regina/article/shame-on-you-10k-worth-of-food-stolen-from-non-profit-seniors-home/

FRANCHISE BANK

WHAT THE FRIDAY: 4 banked (+15 each when found)
- "Abdul El-Sayed asks Fox News' Jesse Watters 'Are you circumcised?' in bizarre moment as he defends sex change surgery for minors https://t.c" (X/Twitter @NYPost, banked 2026-08-24)
- "The bizarre thing Nicole Kidman does to Sandra Bullock when she sees her" (Entertainment Weekly (via Google News), banked 2026-08-29)
- "Tiny mouse brawl breaks out on London subway platform" (nypost.com, banked 2026-09-08)
- "Dramatic video shows naked man being pulled from East River by NYC cops" (nypost.com, banked 2026-09-09)

THROWBACK THURSDAY: 14 banked (+15 each when found)
- "Sonic the Hedgehog to Headline Fortnite's 'Override' Season (Gaming News Roundup)" (variety.com, banked 2026-08-22)
- "Ranch Ehrlo Society celebrates milestone anniversary with powwow" (CTV News (via Google News), banked 2026-08-28)
- "Beyoncé Details Expansive, 27-Track 20th Anniversary 'B'Day' Deluxe Edition Featuring B-Sides, Spanish-Language Versions" (X/Twitter @Billboard, banked 2026-08-28)
- "'A modern Dickie Dee bike': Sask. boy serves up sweet treats with a side of nostalgia https://t.co/tiDR4cbOP1" (X/Twitter @CTVNews, banked 2026-08-30)
- "9/11 cancers skyrocket nearly 1,700% as toxic toll on survivors surpasses first responders ahead of 25th anniversary https://t.co/HWOFfTeKZb" (X/Twitter @NYPost, banked 2026-08-31)

- "Zendaya Rings in 30 with an Adorable Throwback Photo: ‘So Much to Be Grateful for’ - people.com" (People (via Google News), banked 2026-09-01)
- "Here’s Why Fifth Harmony Fans Think the Girl Group Is Making a Comeback Ahead of Anniversary" (X/Twitter @Billboard, banked 2026-09-06)
- "Rachael Leigh Cook surprises fans at ‘Josie and the Pussycats’ 25th anniversary screening" (pagesix.com, banked 2026-09-07)
- "Stevie Wonder Announces ‘Songs in the Key of Life’ 50th Anniversary Tour https://t.co/trmKJsgwqb" (X/Twitter @Variety, banked 2026-09-08)
- "Michael Goodwin: Mamdani’s toxic Ground Zero blame game just latches on to still-open 9/11 wounds to boost himself" (nypost.com, banked 2026-09-08)
- "John Oliver to Host Comic Relief Live’s 40th Anniversary Show" (www.hollywoodreporter.com, banked 2026-09-09)
- "Where I was on 9/11: 4 people in N.L. share their stories of stepping up to help" (www.cbc.ca, banked 2026-09-11)
- "Gander mayor reflects on 25th anniversary of 9/11" (CTV News (via Google News), banked 2026-09-11)
- "Globe editorial: Nostalgia is no strategy for U.S. relations" (The Globe and Mail (via Google News), banked 2026-09-11)

Newly banked this run:
- THROWBACK THURSDAY: "Gander mayor reflects on 25th anniversary of 9/11"
- THROWBACK THURSDAY: "Globe editorial: Nostalgia is no strategy for U.S. relations"

SOURCES SKIPPED THIS RUN:

- @CBCNews (fetch failed)
- @Gizmodo (no posts cleared the 30+ likes bar - 5 below-bar candidate(s) considered for breakout potential)
- 1 story(ies) removed after slotting (content-safety and/or not-significant-enough for THE LIST/TRENDING TODAY; automatically backfilled where possible; see run log)

Scout Report Generated: 2026-09-11 11:43 PM